

Digital Literacy Project Report

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Introduction

This report documents my journey as a newly selected **Student Digital Ambassador**. My role involves helping peers navigate professional online profile creation and safe digital communication. This portfolio consists of five tasks designed to demonstrate core digital competencies, including visual communication, platform mastery, professional etiquette, and cybercrime awareness.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

- **Tool Used:** Canva.
- **Design Overview:** I created a single-page infographic that defines **Digital Literacy**, highlights essential tools like **GitHub and LinkedIn**, and outlines basic **Email Etiquette**. The design uses a clean, professional blue-and-white color scheme to ensure readability for college students.
- **Reflection:** Using Canva was highly intuitive due to its drag-and-drop interface. I found it interesting how much information can be condensed into a single visual without it feeling cluttered. The most difficult part was choosing which three topics to prioritize, as "Digital Literacy" is a broad subject.

Task 2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

- **Platforms Chosen:** GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle.
- **Purpose:**
 - * **GitHub:** For hosting code and collaborating on technical projects.
 - **LinkedIn:** For professional networking and showcasing academic milestones.
 - **Kaggle:** To engage with the data science community and participate in competitions.
- **Future Plans:** Over the next four years, I plan to update my GitHub regularly with course projects and use LinkedIn to connect with alumni and industry professionals for internship opportunities.

Task 3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

- **Platforms Used:** HackerRank and Google Forms.
- **Work Performed:** I successfully completed the '**Solve Me First**' beginner challenge on HackerRank to familiarize myself with competitive coding environments. Additionally, I built a 5-question **Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz** using Google Forms to test my batchmates' knowledge of online safety.
- **Academic Utility:** These tools will help me sharpen my problem-solving skills for technical interviews and allow me to collaborate effectively on group research projects using cloud-based data collection.

Task 4: Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

- **Communication Scenario:** I drafted two emails—one requesting a deadline extension from a professor and another expressing interest in a summer internship to a coordinator.
- **Key Learnings:** I learned that a professional email must be concise, use a clear

subject line, and maintain a respectful tone. Poor digital communication, such as using "SMS language" with a professor, can lead to misunderstandings or a lack of professional credibility. Using a structured sign-off is essential for providing clear contact information.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness & Prevention

- **Research Reflection:** While researching **Phishing**, I was surprised by how sophisticated "Smishing" (SMS phishing) has become in India, often mimicking official bank alerts perfectly.
- **Habit Change:** As a result of this research, I will personally change my habit of clicking links in "urgent" SMS messages. Instead, I will manually navigate to the official website or app to check for notifications. I have also committed to using **Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)** on all my accounts.

Conclusion

This project has significantly enhanced my understanding of the responsibilities that come with a digital presence. Beyond just "using" tools, I have learned how to use them **professionally and safely**. As a Student Digital Ambassador, I feel better equipped to guide my peers in building their own secure and professional digital identities.